



VA CLAIMS

Front-End Design Capabilities

Phase 2 Starter Brief

DRAFT — FOR REVIEW

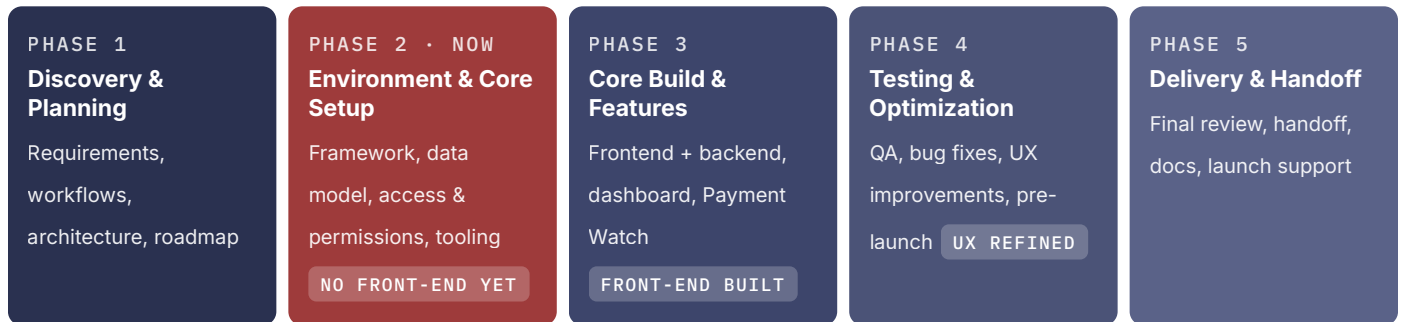
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Where this fits in the roadmap

This brief previews the front-end design direction for the VA Claims software so we can align early. To set expectations clearly: **front-end UI design and build are delivered in Phase 3** and refined in Phase 4. The current phase, **Phase 2, is environment, tools, and core setup — it does not include front-end design**. Sharing direction now lets the Phase 2 groundwork be set up to support the front-end we build next.



Phase focus areas above summarize the signed development roadmap. This document is a design-direction preview only and does not restate or alter any contract, scope, or payment terms.

What Phase 2 enables for the front-end

The setup work happening now directly shapes how cleanly the Phase 3 front-end comes together. A few decisions worth making with the front-end in mind:

- **Component-ready framework choice** — selecting a framework that supports a reusable component model so dashboard and Payment Watch views share consistent UI building blocks.
- **Design-token support** — structuring styling so brand colors, type, and spacing are defined once and applied everywhere, keeping the UI consistent and easy to adjust.
- **Auth & roles the UI will respect** — the user access and permissions planned in Phase 2 define what each role sees; the admin and dashboard UI will render around those roles.
- **Data structure the views bind to** — the backend/database structure should expose the fields the Payment Watch views need (e.g. C&P exam date, day-count grouping, paid status).

In short: Phase 2 stands up the foundation; Phase 3 builds the front-end on top of it. Aligning on direction now reduces rework later.

Front-End Design Capabilities

The front-end design skill set Dillon brings to the VA Claims build, spanning research-driven UX, polished visual design, scalable design systems, and AI-assisted workflows that accelerate exploration and handoff.

UI / UX DESIGN

User experience & visual design

End-to-end interface design — user flows, layout, hierarchy, and high-fidelity visual polish that makes complex workflows feel simple and clear.

DESIGN SYSTEMS

Component libraries & tokens

Reusable component libraries and design tokens (color, type, spacing) so the product stays consistent and scales cleanly as new features are added.

RESPONSIVE

Mobile-first, responsive layouts

Layouts that adapt across desktop, tablet, and phone, so internal staff and clients get a usable experience on whatever device they reach for.

PROTOTYPING

Interactive prototypes

Clickable prototypes to validate flows and gather feedback before development, reducing costly changes later in the build.

ACCESSIBILITY

Accessible by design

WCAG-minded design — readable contrast, clear focus states, larger touch targets, and legible type. Especially important for a veteran and VA-adjacent audience.

BRAND

Brand-consistent UI

Interfaces that carry the VA Claims identity consistently — a trustworthy, professional, government-adjacent visual tone throughout the product.

AI-ASSISTED DESIGN

AI-accelerated front-end design

Using AI to move faster — rapid generative mockups and explorations, AI-accelerated prototyping and iteration, AI-assisted component generation, and copy/imagery exploration. The result is more directions explored in less time and a faster design-to-build handoff. Human review keeps quality and brand fit on track.

HANDOFF

Design-to-development handoff

Clean specs for the build — tokens, redlines, states, and component documentation so what's designed is what gets shipped.

Applied to the VA Claims software

How these capabilities translate to the actual product. The concepts below are an early design direction to react to — specifics are marked [TBD] and to be confirmed with the team.

Main dashboard

A clean, scannable home screen surfacing what staff need first: clients needing attention, Payment Watch status at a glance, and quick navigation into cases. Calm layout, clear hierarchy, minimal visual noise so the important items stand out.

concept – to confirm

Payment Watch view

The Payment Watch feature tracks clients after their C&P exam in two groups. A clear two-column layout separates the groups, with status badges, a manually started timer per client, and simple paid / unpaid management. Concept layout below:

concept – to confirm

60–120 days post C&P exam	121+ days post C&P exam
Client — sample Timer started · day 84 Day 84Unpaid	Client — sample Timer started · day 131 Day 131Unpaid
Client — sample Timer started · day 102 Day 102Paid	Client — sample Timer started · day 156 Day 156Paid
Client — sample Timer not started Start timer	Client — sample Flagged for review Day 174Unpaid

Concept only. Sample rows illustrate the layout — grouping rule (60–120 vs 121+ days), manual timer start, day-count badges, and paid-status toggle reflect the described feature behavior. Exact fields, thresholds, and actions [TBD].

Client / case detail views

A focused per-client view: contact and case summary, C&P exam date and current day-count, Payment Watch status, paid history, and notes. Designed to keep the most-used actions one click away. concept – to confirm

Admin tools & user roles

Admin and management UI built around the access and permissions structure set up in Phase 2 — each role sees and can do only what its permissions allow. Clear, role-aware navigation and controls.

roles & permissions – to confirm with Phase 2 plan

Visual tone

An accessible, trustworthy, government-adjacent visual tone — calm navy and red accents drawn from the VA Claims emblem, high contrast, and generous spacing to convey credibility and reduce cognitive load.

Front-end deliverables Dillon can provide

The concrete design artifacts available for the build. These map to the Phase 3 front-end build and Phase 4 UX polish.

Deliverable	What it includes	Maps to
Wireframes	Low-fidelity layouts of key screens to agree structure and flow before visual design.	Phase 3 build
High-fidelity mockups	Polished, brand-applied screen designs for dashboard, Payment Watch, case detail, and admin.	Phase 3 build
Clickable prototypes	Interactive flows to validate usability and gather feedback before development.	Phase 3 build
Design system / component spec	Reusable components, states, and design tokens (color, type, spacing) for consistency at scale.	Phase 3 build
AI-generated design explorations	Rapid alternative directions and variations to explore options quickly and early.	Phase 3 build
Design-to-dev handoff specs	Tokens, redlines, measurements, and component documentation for accurate implementation.	Phase 3 → 4
UX refinements	Usability improvements and polish based on testing feedback ahead of launch.	Phase 4 polish

Note on timing

These deliverables are sequenced for Phase 3 (front-end build) and Phase 4 (UX improvements). Producing direction and exploration now — during Phase 2 — is preparatory and helps the build start cleanly.

Suggested next steps & open questions

A short list to align on before front-end design work ramps up.

Next steps

- **Confirm Phase 2 vs Phase 3 timing** for design involvement — when front-end direction and mockups should begin relative to the environment setup.
- **Gather brand assets** — logo files, colors, fonts, and any existing guidelines. A transparent / wordmark version of the logo would help, since the current emblem has a dark baked-in background that limits where it can be placed.
- **Confirm target users and devices** — primarily internal staff, clients/veterans, or both? And which devices (desktop, tablet, phone) matter most?
- **Confirm Phase 2 scope** with the team so framework, data model, and access/permissions decisions support the Phase 3 front-end.

Open questions

- Payment Watch — exact day thresholds, timer behavior, and paid-status workflow. [TBD]
- User roles and what each role should see in the dashboard and admin tools. [TBD]
- Accessibility target — any specific WCAG level or compliance requirement to design to? [TBD]
- Branding latitude — how closely should the UI follow the existing emblem palette? [TBD]

About this document

This is a **starter draft** prepared for review. It previews front-end design direction and capabilities; it is not a contract, scope change, or final design spec. Items marked [TBD] and "concept — to confirm" will be refined together. Prepared by Dillon Mohr, Momentum Digital, for James at VA Claims — June 2026.